

RULES OF PLAY

& CONDUCT

for the love of the game

This tournament is played under the official FIBA 3x3 ruleset — the same fast, entertaining format used in the Olympic Games — with a few local adaptations noted throughout. Every player, coach, and team representative is responsible for knowing these rules. Registration is your agreement to abide by them and by the decisions of the referees and Commissioners.

“CAL TECH 17” — WE PLAY TO 17

Every Pervis Polk Cup game is played to 17 points (not the usual 21). It honors a pickup game Pervis Polk and co-founder Ron Wilson once played at Caltech — across the street from the Pasadena Poly courts where they hooped for years. That day's games went to 17, an unusual number in pickup culture, and the two never forgot it. The CHAMPIONSHIP game is the lone exception, played to the traditional 21.

01 – The Basics

Item	Rule
Players on court	3 vs 3, plus up to 2 substitutes (5-person roster max).
Court	One half-court per game, single hoop. 4 courts run simultaneously.
Ball	Official 3x3 ball (size 6, weight of a size 7).
Eligibility	Open division. Males & females ages 16+. Players 16–17 only with a parent/guardian waiver and written approval from Commissioners Ron Wilson or Jerrid Dorsey.
Officials	4 referees rotate across 4 courts; Commissioners have final authority.

02 – Game Length & How to Win

- A game ends when the first team reaches 17 points (“Cal Tech 17”) OR when 10 minutes of game clock have elapsed — whichever comes first.
- The CHAMPIONSHIP game is the exception: it is played to 21 points OR 10 minutes.
- The clock stops on dead balls and free throws (as officials direct). In pool play, games may run on a continuous clock if the schedule requires — the Commissioners will announce the format before play.
- If a team reaches the target score before time expires, that team wins immediately.
- If the score is tied at the end of regulation, the game goes to overtime.

Overtime

- Teams reset briefly. The team that started the game on DEFENSE gets first possession in overtime.

- First team to score 2 points in overtime wins. (No time cap in OT — play to 2.)

03 – Scoring

Shot	Points
Made basket inside the arc	1 point
Made basket behind the arc	2 points
Made free throw	1 point

Note for 5-on-5 players: in 3x3 a “three-pointer” counts as 2 and everything else counts as 1. Plan your shot selection accordingly.

04 – Possession, Check-Ball & Restarts

- Coin toss: A toss (or quick free-throw shoot-for-it) before the game decides first possession. The winner takes first possession of the game OR of a potential overtime — not both.
- Start of game: begins with a check-ball at the top (behind the arc), not a jump ball.
- After every made basket: the team scored on takes the ball; a defender checks it live; the offense must clear it (player and ball) behind the arc before attacking.
- Clearing: after a defensive rebound or steal, the ball must be taken behind the arc before a shot attempt counts.
- Check-ball on stoppages: when play stops with no clear control, the team last on defense gets the check-ball.

05 – Fouls & Free Throws

Situation	Result
Foul on a shot inside the arc	1 free throw
Foul on a shot behind the arc	2 free throws
Shooting foul + made basket	Count the basket + 1 free throw
Team fouls 1–6	Normal play; check-ball to the offense
Team fouls 7, 8, 9 (bonus)	2 free throws to the fouled team — no possession after
Team foul 10+	2 free throws AND possession to the fouled team
Technical foul	1 free throw + possession
Unsportsmanlike foul	2 free throws + possession

A team is in the penalty (bonus) once it has committed 6 team fouls. The 10th team foul and every foul after is automatically treated as a technical.

06 – Shot Clock & Stalling

- The shot clock is 12 seconds. A team must attempt a shot that hits the rim within 12 seconds of gaining possession.
- If the venue cannot run a visible clock on all courts, referees use a verbal/visual count. The Commissioners will announce the method before play.

- Failure to attempt within the clock = turnover; ball to the other team via check-ball.

07 – Substitutions & Timeouts

- Substitutions happen only on a dead ball with the clock stopped; the incoming player enters after the outgoing player steps off behind the end line opposite the basket.
- Each team gets ONE 30-second timeout per game, callable by any player on a dead ball.
- Rosters lock at check-in. A player may appear on only ONE team's roster for the tournament.

08 – Standings, Seeding & Tiebreakers

Day 1 is pool play (10 pools of 5, full round-robin — every team plays 4 games). Pool standings are ranked, in order, by:

1. Number of wins (out of 4).
2. Head-to-head result between the tied teams.
3. Point differential across pool games (capped at ± 10 per game).
4. Total points scored in pool games.
5. Free-throw shoot-out between team captains if still tied.

The full 1–50 seed list sets Sunday's brackets: top 16 → Championship, 17–32 → Consolation, 33–50 → Community. See the separate Day-2 Seeding Key.

09 – Prizes & Awards

- CHAMPION and RUNNER-UP receive cash prizes (\$1,350 and \$750).
- All four podium teams — Champion, Runner-Up, 3rd Place, and Consolation Champion — receive commemorative hats and free entry to the next Pervis Polk Cup.
- The Championship winner takes home the Pervis Polk Cup.

CODE OF CONDUCT

on the court · on the sideline · in the building

Pervis Polk mentored generations of Pasadena athletes. This event carries his name, so it carries his standard. We compete hard and we carry ourselves right. These rules are enforced by referees and Commissioners and apply to players, coaches, family, and guests.

10 – On-Court Conduct

- Respect every official's call. Referees rule the court; Commissioners have final say. Arguing a call does not reverse it — it costs you.
- No trash talk targeting a person, family, race, gender, or origin. Competitive fire is welcome; personal attacks are not.
- No fighting, shoving, or retaliation — ever. Instigator and retaliator can both be removed.
- Self-officiating spirit: 3x3 moves fast — call your own obvious fouls and play with integrity.
- Hustle on and off between games to keep the two-day schedule moving — every team's experience depends on it.

11 – Off-Court & Spectator Conduct

- Treat Blair High School property with care. Clean up after your team.
- Strictly no alcohol, drugs, tobacco, or vaping anywhere on school grounds.
- No weapons of any kind.
- Keep sideline language family-friendly — children are present.
- Spectators: cheer loud, stay positive. Spectator misconduct can penalize or remove a player's team.

12 – Discipline & Ejections

Offense	Consequence
Technical foul	Free throw + possession to opponent
Two technicals (one player)	Ejection from that game
Unsportsmanlike / fighting	Immediate ejection; possible removal with NO refund
Ejected player	Must leave the playing area; may be barred from future events
Team-wide misconduct	Forfeit and/or removal, at Commissioners' discretion

Disciplinary decisions by Commissioners Ron Wilson and Jerrid Dorsey are final.

13 – Health, Safety & Weather

- Play at your own risk. A signed liability waiver must be on file before any player steps on the court.
- A first-aid station and ice are at the tournament table. Report any injury to staff immediately.
- Hydrate — August in Pasadena is hot. Water stations provided; bring your own bottle.
- In extreme heat, lightning, or emergency, Commissioners may pause, shorten, or postpone play. Safety first.

14 – Spirit of the Game

LEAVE IT BETTER

Win or lose, leave it better than you found it — the court, the scoreboard, and the people around you. That is how Pervis did it, and that is how we honor him.